

Meridian Labs — Organisation Overview

Meridian Labs is an independent research organisation working on coastal climate instrumentation. It was founded in 2019 in Lisbon, Portugal, and operates a second workshop in Tromsø, Norway.

Leadership

Meridian Labs is directed by Dr. Amara Okonkwo, an oceanographer who previously led the sensor group at the Halden Institute. Okonkwo took over as director in 2021, succeeding Tomas Ferreira, who remains on the advisory board.

Engineering is led by Priya Raghunathan, who joined Meridian in 2020 from a background in low-power embedded systems. Raghunathan designed the Wavelet sensor platform that most of the organisation's fieldwork now depends on.

Programmes

The organisation runs two long-lived programmes.

The Kepler Initiative is a joint tidal-monitoring programme with the Halden Institute, begun in 2022. Kepler operates a network of forty-one buoys along the Atlantic shelf and publishes its readings openly.

Wavelet is the in-house sensor platform: a low-power buoy-mounted unit that records temperature, salinity and wave height. Wavelet units are manufactured in Tromsø and deployed by both Meridian and its partners.

Funding

Meridian Labs is funded by the Costa Foundation, a private endowment based in Lisbon, together with grant support from the Nordic Marine Council. The Costa Foundation has supported the organisation since its founding and funds roughly two-thirds of its annual budget.